



Jumping the gap

A quasi particle that travels along the interface of metal-dielectric could help shrink electronics further. <https://digit.in/oct19-83>



NASA's plans for Titan

Shapeshifter' is NASA's new morphing robot which could be used to explore Saturn's moon Titan in the future. <https://digit.in/oct19-84>

Sony A9G 55-inch 4K UHD Smart TV

A sight to behold!

Sony's 2019 flagship, the A9G is a sight to behold and brings with it an interesting feature set. Is it one that deserves your attention, though?

Build and design

The TV is slim with the bulge at the back housing the connectivity options and the motherboard of the TV. The placement of the ports is pretty standard. The beauty of this TV is the cable management it brings with it.

The TV has really slim bezels. There is a small white LED at the bottom of the TV but you can control its intensity in the TV's UI. If you decide to put the TV on a tabletop, know that there is no space between the base of the TV and the table to house a console or a soundbar.



Price
₹2,99,900



FEATURES.....	88
PERFORMANCE.....	95
VALUE.....	90
DESIGN.....	88

The A9G supports eARC and all the ports are HDCP 2.3 compatible. With eARC, consumers will be able to get DTS-X and Dolby Atmos audio from the TV to compatible audio gear.

Sony's Acoustic Surface technology makes an appearance here as well and is one of the better sounding

and it is easy to navigate through. You can add certain settings you'd like to change to this bar at the bottom as well.

We get the upgraded remote control with the A9G. It comes with a textured back giving it a good grip. Unlike the LG TV UI, Sony's TV remote still doesn't have a mouse feature and typing is still manually navigating the onscreen keyboard, but you can use the Android TV app on your smartphone to make the typing process easier.

Display and picture quality

The Sony A9G has an OLED panel with support for 4K resolution along with HDR 10 and Dolby Vision support. It also has a 'Netflix Mode'. The TV brings with it Dolby Vision Bright and Dolby Vision Dark for HDR content. OLED panels are quite reflective, so if you use the TV in a brightly lit room, then this is one thing you may want to keep in mind.

Performance

The A9G has the X1 Ultimate chip powering it. The visuals were tested by firing up our test sequences of Altered Carbon using the built-in Netflix app and the first frame immersed me. The dynamic range and peak brightness make the content look immersive and detailed. If you watch this sequence in a pitch dark room, then the deep blacks, courtesy of the OLED panel are a treat.

HDR content exhibited the same amount of detail in as well. We played a lot of FHD content is presented beautifully as well.

TV speakers that we've tested. Dialogue is clear, music is enjoyable but the overall punch is missing, especially during action movies or games.

UI and remote control

The A9G is running on Android TV 8. The overall experience is butter smooth. There was not one moment, be it when gaming on a console, streaming using the native apps or when logging into the play store that the UI didn't respond. One of the best things about the Sony TV is to switch it on and off by simply using your voice. Know that this will only happen when you keep the TV in standby mode. But it is really cool if you don't know where you left the remote.

There are some subtle changes to the UI, again. If you want to change sources, picture or audio settings, you don't need to pull up the right side navigation bar to hamper the viewing experience. For basic setting changes like picture mode, audio, source and more, a small strip comes up at the bottom of the display

Verdict

The Sony A9G is a flagship OLED TV to consider. There is little one can say in terms of cons for the TV. The only one I can think of is that it sits flush when kept on a tabletop. But here is the question to answer, which Sony 2019 flagship, namely the X95G or the A9G is the one for you? Well, if you watch TV in a well-lit room, then go for the X95G as the VA panel does a slightly better job of reflection handling. But, if you watch TV in a relatively dark room and are looking for a cinematic experience, then the A9G is the way to go.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL SIZE: 55-inch (available in 65-inch as well) | PANEL TYPE: OLED | PANEL RESOLUTION: 3840 x 2160 - 4K | PANEL REFRESH RATE: 120Hz | HDR 10 SUPPORT: Yes | DOLBY VISION SUPPORT: Yes | WEIGHT (WITH STAND): 22.3kg | HDMI PORTS: 4 | USB PORTS: 3 | BLUETOOTH: Yes | WI-FI: Yes | ETHERNET: Yes | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 16GB

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